Project Report: Digital Literacy Portfolio

Name: Irfan Alam Ansari

Registration Number: 25BAI11088

Branch: CSE(AI&ML)

Year: First Year

Course Code: CSE0001

Date: 30/03/26

Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador, my primary responsibility is to mentor my peers in navigating the complexities of the modern digital landscape. This project serves as a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, demonstrating my ability to manage professional online identities, utilise collaborative cloud tools, and promote cyber safety. Throughout this assignment, I have completed five distinct tasks mapped to the course modules, ranging from visual communication and technical skill-building to professional ethics and cybercrime prevention. The objective of this portfolio is to provide a repository of resources that can help my batchmates study, practice, and communicate safely and effectively in a digital-first academic environment

Task 1 Write-up: Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I designed a one-page visual infographic titled "Digital Literacy Essentials for Students" using Canva. The design focuses on three core areas: defining digital literacy, highlighting useful academic tools like GitHub and Google Workspace, and outlining safe internet practices. I chose a clean, modern layout with high-contrast colours to ensure the information is easily digestible for my peers.

The most interesting part of this process was learning how to condense complex topics—like phishing and professional networking—into simple, actionable icons. One difficulty I encountered was balancing the amount of text with the visual elements to keep the infographic professional yet engaging. Ultimately, this tool will serve as a quick-reference guide for my batch during our transition into high-tech learning environments.

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

In this module, I established my professional foundation by setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms were selected because they are the industry standards for technical collaboration, professional networking, and data science community engagement. On GitHub, I created a profile README to introduce myself to the global developer community, while on LinkedIn, I updated my academic background to reflect my current status as a B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as a living record of my projects and code. I intend to use LinkedIn to connect with alumni and industry professionals to stay informed about internship opportunities and industry trends. Building this presence early ensures that I am digitally discoverable and professional by the time I apply for placements.

Task 3 Write-up: Platforms & Collaboration

This task involved demonstrating technical proficiency and cloud collaboration skills. For the coding segment, I used HackerRank to solve the Python challenge. Practicing on these platforms is essential for developing the logic-building skills required for technical interviews.

Additionally, I created a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms to test my peers' knowledge of online safety and tool usage. I linked the form to a Google Sheet to track responses in real-time, showcasing how cloud tools can be used for data collection and batch-wide collaboration. These tools will help me academically by allowing me to collaborate on group projects efficiently and maintain a consistent schedule of coding practice alongside my coursework.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Communication

Effective digital communication is a cornerstone of the Digital Ambassador role. I drafted two professional emails: a request for an assignment extension and an internship inquiry. Both drafts focused on maintaining a respectful tone, using clear subject lines, and following formal structures. I also developed a 10-point social media checklist to encourage responsible online behaviour among students.

A key learning from this task is that a lack of "digital etiquette" can lead to missed opportunities; for instance, an informal email to a recruiter might result in an application being ignored. I have learned that professional greetings and clear signatures are not just formalities but essential tools for building credibility

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness

Researching Phishing for this task revealed how sophisticated online threats have become. I was most surprised to learn that attackers often use the psychological pressure of "urgency" to trick even tech-savvy students into revealing their UPI PINs or login credentials.

As a result of this research, I will personally change my habit of clicking links in "urgent" emails without first verifying the sender's full email address and the URL's security. I have also integrated the National Cyber Crime Portal details (1930) into my prevention checklist to ensure my peers know exactly where to turn if they encounter fraud.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy Portfolio has reinforced that being a student in the 21st century requires more than just academic knowledge; it requires a professional and safe digital presence. Through these tasks, I have moved from a passive user of technology to an active, responsible digital citizen. I now feel confident in my ability to manage a GitHub repository, communicate professionally with faculty, and protect my digital identity from common cyber threats. These competencies will remain a permanent part of my professional toolkit throughout my engineering journey.

References

- **GitHub:** github.com
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com
- **Kaggle:** Kaggle.com
- **Canva:** canva.com
- **HackerRank:** hackerrank.com
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in